

News Report 1

Two buses and two other vehicles crashed early Wednesday on a highway in western Uganda, **killing 46 people**, police said, in one of the worst motor accidents in the East African country in recent years. Several others were injured in the crash that happened after midnight local time on the highway to Gulu, a major city in northern Uganda.

Two bus drivers going in opposite directions attempted to overtake other vehicles and collided near the town of Kiryandongo, according to police. "In the process, both buses met head-on during the overtaking maneuvers," the police statement said.

In Uganda, **5,144 people were killed in road crashes in 2024**. That number rose from 4,806 in 2023 and 4,534 in 2022, according to official police figures, which show a rise in the total number of those killed or injured in road crashes in recent years.

"As investigations continue, we strongly urge all motorists to exercise maximum caution on the roads, especially avoiding **dangerous and careless overtaking, which remains one of the leading causes of crashes in the country**," the police said in their statement after the latest crash.

Question 11

How many people were killed in the latest crash in western Uganda?

- A. 36
 - B. 40
 - C. 46**
 - D. 56
-

Question 12

How many people were killed in road crashes in Uganda in 2024?

- A. 4,534
 - B. 4,806
 - C. 5,144**
 - D. 5,600
-

Question 13

According to the police, what remains one of the leading causes of crashes in the country?

- A. Speeding at night
- B. Careless overtaking**
- C. Driving without a seatbelt
- D. Poor weather conditions

答案： C,C,B

News Report 2:

Character.AI, an app that allows users to create customizable characters or interact with those generated by others is banning minors from using its chatbots **amid growing concerns about the effects of artificial intelligence conversations on children.** The company is facing several lawsuits over child safety, including by the mother of a teenager who says the company's chatbots pushed her teenage son to kill himself.

Character Technologies, the California-based company behind Character.AI, said Wednesday it will be removing the ability of users under 18 to participate in open-ended chats with AI characters. The changes will go into effect by Nov. 25 and **a two-hour daily limit will start immediately.** Character.AI added that it is working on new features for kids — such as the ability to create videos, stories, and streams with AI characters.

Character.AI said it will be rolling out age-verification functions to help determine which users are under 18. A growing number of tech platforms are turning to age checks to keep children from accessing tools that are not safe for them.

Critics welcomed the move but said it is not enough — and should have been done earlier. Meetali Jain, executive director of the Tech Justice Law Project, said, “There are still a lot of details left open.”

“They have not addressed how they will operationalize age verification, how they will ensure their methods are privacy preserving, nor have they addressed the possible psychological impact of suddenly disabling access to young users, given the emotional dependencies that have been created,” Jain said. **“Moreover, these changes do not address the underlying design features that facilitate these emotional dependencies – not just for children, but also for people over the age of 18 years old.”**

Question 14

Why is Character.AI banning minors from using its chatbots?

- A) Due to complaints about the app's poor performance
- B) Due to concerns and lawsuits related to children**
- C) To launch a new, separate app just for children
- D) To comply with new government regulations

Question 15

Which change will be implemented immediately for users under 18?

- A) Deletion of all their account data
- B) A new child-safe warning message
- C) A two-hour daily limit on app use**
- D) A new process to verify user age

Question 16

According to the critic Meetal Jain, who can develop emotional dependence due to the platform's design?

- A. Only teenagers using AI frequently
- B. Only users with psychological problems
- C. Both minors and adults over 18**
- D. Mainly parents monitoring their children

答案 : B, C, C

News Report 3:

This week, Swiss Federal Railways (or SBB) announced plans for a new night train called EuroNight. It will go from Basel in Switzerland to Copenhagen in Denmark and Malmö in Sweden.

A company spokesperson said the new service makes eco-friendly trips to Northern Europe easier for people. It also helps meet the rising need for green travel across borders.

The EuroNight will run three times a week in both directions. The first trip is set to start on April 15, 2026. The train will cover about 1,400 kilometers and carry around 350 passengers. Tickets for the service will go on sale from November 4, 2025.

Night trains are quickly becoming a favorite way to travel in Europe. But high costs are slowing down their growth.

Recently, Austria's rail company ÖBB said it will stop its night trains from Paris to Vienna and Berlin starting in mid-December, following the French government's withdrawal of funding.

The plan for this new sleeper train from Switzerland to Sweden is not final yet. The rail company is waiting for government money to be approved.

The Swiss government has set aside €50.6 million until 2030 to help international night trains. This is part of the CO2 Act, which aims to cut the country's emissions in half over the next five years. But parliament still needs to approve it in the winter session.

If the money is not approved, SBB says it will inform customers and refund any tickets that have already been booked.

Question 17

What route will the new EuroNight train take?

- A) From Paris to Vienna and Berlin
 - B) From Basel to Copenhagen and Malmö**
 - C) From Zurich to Munich and Hamburg
 - D) From Geneva to Oslo and Stockholm
-

Question 18

When is the first EuroNight trip scheduled to begin?

- A) November 4, 2025
 - B) December 2025
 - C) April 15, 2026**
 - D) Mid-December 2026
-

Question 19

Why will some night train services be stopped by Austria's rail company ÖBB?

- A) Because passenger numbers have dropped sharply.
 - B) Because some trains have become too old.
 - C) Because new safety rules increased the costs.
 - D) Because the French government withdrew funding.**
-

Question 20

What will SBB do if the government funding is not approved?

- A) Raise ticket prices
- B) Reduce weekly trips
- C) Delay the train service
- D) Refund booked tickets**

答案： B, C, D, D